

Rushdie & Roy: Exercises Only

Private practice for Hana and Aiden

Rule for every page: borrow the move, not the exact wording. Use normal English words. Do not copy the fragment into your own answer.

1. Rushdie: Pressure From The Past

"handcuffed to history"

Salman Rushdie, *Midnight's Children* (1981)

A. Translate the image

What kind of pressure could make a person feel trapped by the past?

B. Choose stronger nouns

Complete four phrases using precise nouns: reputation, promise, guilt, duty, expectation, memory, rumour.

C. Make four new metaphors

Write four sentences about a child trapped by family expectation. Use normal words such as chained, weighed down, locked, dragged, buried or caught.

D. Tiny scene

Write five lines in which a child enters school carrying an invisible burden from home.

2. Rushdie: A Whole World Inside One Person

"swallow a world"

Salman Rushdie, *Midnight's Children* (1981)

A. Build the hidden world

List six things that could live inside a complicated person: places, smells, memories, fears, languages, secrets, sounds or loyalties.

B. Avoid the obvious

Do not say 'he was complicated'. Show the complication through three concrete details.

C. New sentence frames

Write three sentences beginning: To understand her, you had to... Use ordinary verbs such as enter, cross, unlock, carry, read or listen to.

D. Paragraph

Introduce a new pupil who seems to carry another place inside him or her.

3. Rushdie: Make An Abstract Force Physical

A. Convert the invisible

Turn each abstract noun into something physical: history, pride, guilt, jealousy, homesickness, ambition.

B. Choose the best verb

For each noun, pick a verb that gives it force: presses, drags, stains, locks, follows, weighs, burns, grips.

C. Sentence practice

Write six sentences where an invisible feeling acts on a character's body.

D. Sharpen one

Choose your best sentence and rewrite it twice: once darker, once funnier.

4. Roy: Weather With A Mood

"hot, brooding month"

Arundhati Roy, *The God of Small Things* (1997)

A. Mood bank

Write five weather moods using normal adjectives: brooding, restless, watchful, airless, sullen, impatient, uneasy, tender.

B. Match weather to story

Choose weather for: the morning of an exam, the hour before an argument, the day after a secret is discovered.

C. Sentence practice

Write four sentences in which the weather suggests emotion before any character speaks.

D. Tiny scene

Describe the first minute of a family meal where everyone knows something is wrong. Let the weather do some of the work.

5. Roy: A Body-Shaped Adverb

"fatly baffled in the sun"

Arundhati Roy, *The God of Small Things* (1997)

A. Keep it real

Use only normal English adverbs. Replace 'very' with posture: stiffly, heavily, sharply, awkwardly, brightly, weakly, proudly, slowly.

B. Emotion through posture

Write four sentences where an adverb shows embarrassment, fear, pride or guilt without naming the emotion.

C. Add the setting

Place each sentence in heat, rain, a corridor, a kitchen or a classroom. Let the setting press on the body.

D. Improve one sentence

Choose your best sentence and remove one weak word. Replace it with a more precise verb or adverb.

6. Roy: Setting As Warning

A. Before the event

Describe a place five minutes before bad news arrives. Do not mention the bad news.

B. Small details

Add three ordinary details that feel slightly wrong: a fan, a glass, a window, a clock, a chair, a curtain.

C. Mood without naming mood

Write three versions of the same room: anxious, excited, ashamed. Do not use those three words.

7. Mixed Drill: Rushdie Pressure + Roy Atmosphere

A. Two-sentence drill

Sentence 1: make the weather carry the mood. Sentence 2: make an invisible pressure act on the character.

B. Rewrite bland sentences

Improve these: 'He felt nervous.' 'The day was hot.' 'She had a difficult family.' 'The room was quiet.'

C. No copying test

Write a paragraph inspired by the two authors' moves, but do not use the words handcuffed, history, swallow, world, hot, brooding, fatly or baffled.

8. Final Writing Challenge

Choose one task. Spend 20 minutes. Use at least one pressure metaphor and one atmosphere sentence. Use normal English words only.

Option A

A child arrives at a new school with a family secret everyone else seems to know.

Option B

A family dinner begins in silence after someone has broken an important promise.

Option C

A clever, lonely child meets someone who seems to carry an entire place inside them.

Final check: Have I shown pressure? Have I made the setting carry emotion? Have I used precise normal words? Have I avoided copying the fragments?